PHOTOGRAPHY

THE MYSTIC GAZE

Photographer **Bandeep Singh**'s exhibition *Bhasmang* in Delhi delves deep into the lives of the Naga sadhus





"For a lot of people, Naga sadhus are a spectacle and nothing more," rues photographer Bandeep Singh whose exhibition *Bhasmang: The Way of the Naga Sadhus* opens at Delhi's Travancore House on February 24, and can be viewed till March 2.

With millions having visited the Mahakumbh this year, and the prolific imagery of the Naga sadhus that we've already been inundated by, one would imagine yet another collection of pictures may fail to impress. But we'd be wrong; Singh's photographs exhibit not only his incredible mastery over light but also the access he has attained into the *akhada*s. After his first tryst with the Kumbh in 2013, and having made personal connections over the years with visits to their ashrams and deras, especially in Haridwar, Singh was even invited to set up a studio of sorts inside the Juna Akhada in 2019! "They eventually registered my presence as a person who's not out there to seek the image and scoot away. That I had the curiosity, to listen to them, to open up to them and



GREEN ELEGANCE Method gallery in Delhi's Defence Colony

GALLERY

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